

1901–1916

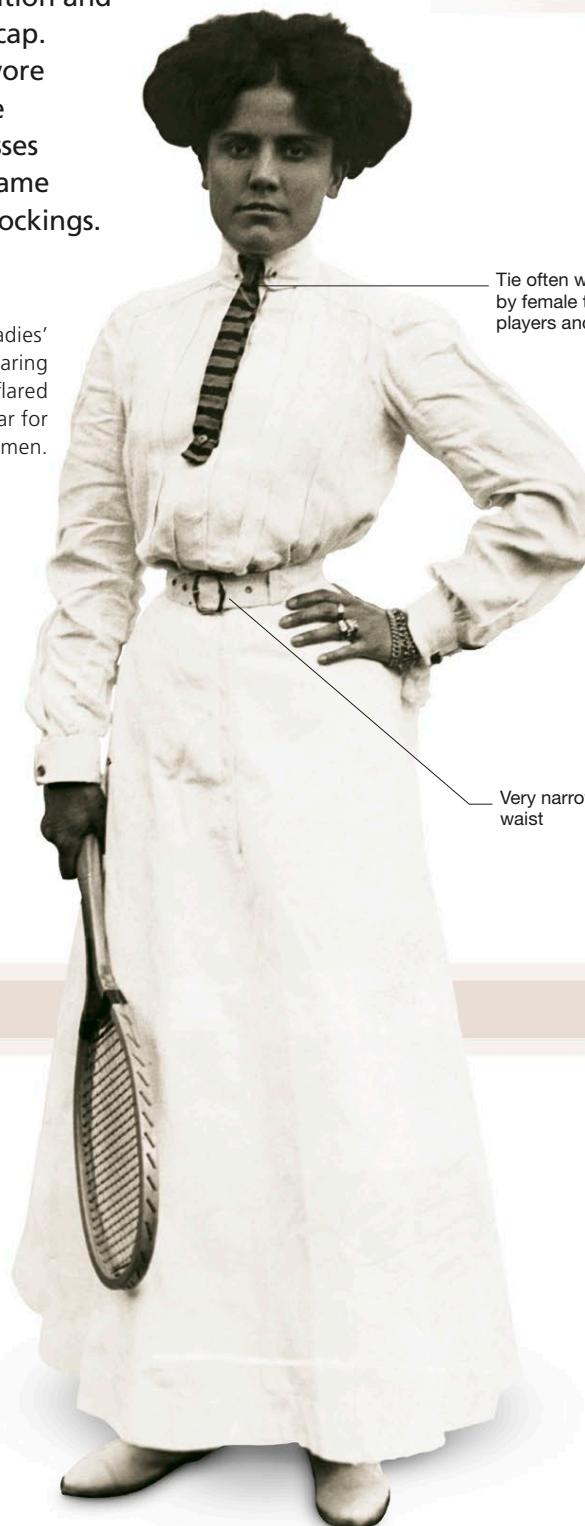
WOMEN IN ACTION

Until World War I women's sportswear followed the fashionable silhouette and included garments that could also be worn in other contexts. The "tailor-made" (a suit), and the shirtwaist (simple blouse) and skirt combination were often adapted for sport. For cycling, hiking, and fencing, women could wear divided skirts or bloomers, provided they covered their legs with high, laced-up boots or gaiters. Sportswear usually had minimal surface decoration and was often paired with a manly cravat and flat cap. Even when playing tennis or cycling, women wore corsets, but these were often smaller and more lightly boned than usual. The knee-length dresses worn over bloomers for bathing gradually became shorter, but continued to be worn with dark stockings.

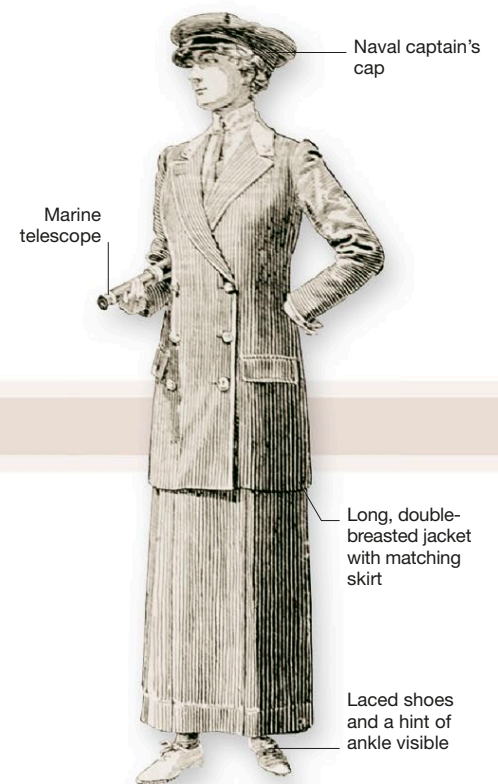
Tennis Dora Boothby, winner of the ladies' singles title at Wimbledon in 1909, is wearing a corset with her white shirtwaist and flared skirt. White canvas shoes were popular for tennis with men and women.



Motoring Most early cars were open, and to travel comfortably the entire body and face needed protection. Clothing included a long coat of light-coloured fabric called a duster, goggles, and motoring bonnets or veils to shield the face.



Cycling The divided skirt is the only really practical part of this cycling outfit from just before the turn of the century. Shorter corsets were sometimes worn for sport.



Yachting The English firm of Burberry supplied a variety of clothes for women and men for summer and winter sports. The relatively short skirt of this yachting gown, worn with a manly tie and flat cap, reveals practical footwear.